

Language history: Quick facts

FORTRAN

Formula **t**ranslation

John Backus and others - IBM (US)

Mathematical and scientific processing

BASIC

Beginners' **A**ll-purpose **S**ymbolic **I**nstruction **C**ode

John Kemeny, Thomas Kurtz - Dartmouth College (US)

Teaching language

ALGOL

Algorithmic Language

Committee of European and American scientists

General-purpose programming

Simula I, Simula 67

Ole-Johan Dahl, Kristen Nygaard (Norway)

Earliest object-oriented language

Pascal

Niklaus Wirth (Switzerland)

Teaching language

Named for Blaise Pascal: mathematician, philosopher, inventor of an early calculating machine

Ada

Jean Ichbiah and others (France)

U.S. Department of Defense

Safety-critical systems

Named for Augusta Ada Byron King, Countess of Lovelace: early programmer, defining algorithms for Charles Babbage's Analytical Engine

C

Dennis Ritchie - Bell Labs (US)

Unix operating system

Efficiency

C++

Bjarne Stroustrup - Bell Labs (Denmark/US)

Add classes to C (preserves backward compatibility with C); hybrid OO

Java

James Gosling - Sun Microsystems (Canada/US)

Object-oriented C-like language (breaks backward compatibility with C)

FLOW-MATIC

Grace Hopper and others, Remington Rand (US)

Business data processing

Used English-like phrases

COBOL

Common **b**usiness **O**riented **L**anguage

Committee of scientists from several American computer corporations and government agencies

U.S. Department of Defense

Business data processing

Used English-like phrases

Smalltalk

Alan Kay, Adele Goldberg, Dan Ingalls, and others at Xerox PARC (US)

An early and influential object-oriented language

sed

“stream **editor**”

Text file processing

Lee McMahon - Bell Labs (US)

awk

Alfred Aho, Peter Weinberger, Brian Kernighan - Bell Labs (Canada/US)

Text file processing

Perl

Larry Wall (US)

Originally for text file processing and report generation

Python

Guido van Rossum (Netherlands)

Named for Monty Python

Ruby

Yukihiro Matsumoto (Japan)

Object-oriented scripting language

Lua

Roberto Ierusalimschy, Waldemar Celes, Luiz Henrique de Figueiredo (Brazil)

Lua means *moon* in Portuguese. Lua was influenced by SOL (*sun*).

PHP

Rasmus Lerdorf (Greenland/Canada)

Web development

JavaScript

Brendan Eich and others - Netscape (US)

Web development